sister to me. No doubt she'll be embarrassed that I'm saying this – but that's Donné for you. She'll do anything in the world to help you, but she gets all *skaam* when praises are heaped on her. Donné is exceptionally hard-working, and she makes sure that I'm up to date with my finances.

She's also fiercely protective of my welfare, always saying, 'Herschelle, I don't want people to take advantage of you just because they think you have money.' And she's right – I do tend to get a little overly generous when I'm out with my mates. In the past, some folk also tried to make some extra cash off me – I know of a couple of estate agents whose little ruses have been shot out of the sky by Donné. Ja. She's a lawyer too.

Besides that, though, Donné has always been there for me on a personal level as well. I trust her 100 per cent. Let me put it this way: the first person I would call when I'm in trouble is Donné. I know this for a fact, because whenever I got into trouble over the years, Donné was always the first person I called. On the odd occasion when I was in the dwang and didn't call her, she kakked me out properly.

It doesn't matter what I do, I reckon not telling Donné first is always the scarier option! I have the greatest respect for her. She's a great human being, and a world-class manager and agent. I mean, the woman has three small kids of her own, *and* she has the big kids she represents … me, Bouchie, JP Duminy and the two Morkels, Albie and Morné.

Basically Donné allows me to concentrate on my cricket and enjoy life, while she does all the hard work. And ja, for me the world would have been a very different place if I hadn't had her in my life for the past 10 years. She's just a great individual, end of story. I could never, ever thank her enough.

Right, so back to the little decision I had to make. I thought about it for quite a while – about three weeks or so. A large part of me still wanted to deny everything, but there was a nagging voice inside my head insisting that I do the right thing. Donné and my lawyer, Peter Whelan, helped me a lot in that tough time. Eventually I phoned Donné and said, 'Okay, fine, if they want me to check into rehab, I'll check in.' I heard an audible sigh of relief over the phone. And that was it. I flew back home to Cape Town.

If you think this sounds like I was going into rehab only to satisfy other people's wishes, then you'd be spot-on. I didn't believe I was an alcoholic, and I still don't believe it. Sure I was drinking too much and sure it was